

Acquire for consent:

Thank you for agreeing to speak with me. This interview is voluntary and confidential; you may skip any question or stop at any time; I will de-identify your responses and won't share identifying details without your consent. Do you agree to continue?

Everything you share will be kept private and confidential. This means your name and identity will not appear in any reports or papers, and nothing will be linked back to you. Some of the things you say may be used in research publications, but always in a way that protects your identity.

Interview starts:

1. Can you tell me a bit about yourself (age range, relationship status, general online habits)?
2. Which platforms/apps did you use most before this happened?
3. Would you please go through the event from the beginning? What happened, from first contact to how you responded, and how did it affect you?

Please make sure the interview includes the following details (see checklist), you can use the following questions to prompt the participants to provide more details:

Can I know your age and sexual orientation?

How did the person first contact you (app, DM, email, other)? And When?

And have you ever checked the attacker's social media profile to verify its authenticity?

What drew you to continue the conversation at first?

Before requesting nude/explicit photos, did the victim request a voice or video call with the attacker? And how often?

Did you or the other person suggest an in-person date? If rejected, what was the reason?

During your interactions with her/him, what do you think made you feel that you could fully trust her/him?

At roughly what stage did this "complete trust" appear? Was it when you first started chatting, or later, when you began having frequent video calls and sharing more intimate content?

When did the request for a nude/explicit photo first occur in the conversation? (early/after several messages/after a period of flirting)

How exactly was the request framed (e.g., flirtatious, as a "favor," for verification, as part of a relationship)? (Phantom Riches by cryptocurrency investment, favor due to financial difficulties)

How did you feel when they asked? What made you decide to send or refuse?

Did the requester present themselves as a particular identity (age, gender, job, location, identity (a soldier, celebrity, or internet celebrity))? Did anything about that identity feel suspicious?

Were there specific prompts or directions about how to take the photo (poses, angles, faces shown or hidden)?

When did the coercion begin (immediate, after a delay, after previous content was shared)?

What form did the blackmail take (threats to share photos publicly, send to family/work, extortion for money)?

What demands were made (money, more photos, silence, other actions)? Were deadlines given?

Were you asked to pay? If yes — how (method) and how much?

Did you comply with payment requests? If so, can you say why you chose to pay (fear, coercion, belief it would stop, embarrassment)?

How did the blackmail affect your emotions (shame, fear, anger, anxiety)?

Did it affect your sleep, work, relationships, or daily routine? How?

Did you change any online behaviors (delete accounts, stop using apps, change privacy settings)?

Did you consider or attempt to negotiate with the blackmailer? What happened?

Did you report the incident to the platform, the police, or another authority? Why or why not? What response did you receive?

Did you talk to friends, family, or a professional about this? What was their reaction?

When you faced difficulties or distress in your everyday offline life because of this experience, did you try to seek any support or help (For example, psychological counseling, psychotherapy, medical treatment, or talking to religious/community leaders or other people you trust) ?

Has the attacker extorted you many times, or only once? How many times have you experienced this in total?

Perceptions of stigma & masculinity

4. Did concerns about masculinity, shame, or social stigma influence your decisions (to report, to tell others, to seek help)? How?

5. Did you worry about being judged differently because you are a man? If so, in what ways?

6. Could you tell me where your sense of shame in this experience comes from?

7. Do you feel that this shame is related to cultural or social norms around sex in the place where you

grew up (for example, how open people are about sex or how sexual behavior is judged in your country/community)?

8. What, if anything, do you think the platform should have done to prevent or address this?
9. What features or policies would have made you feel safer when using the app?
10. Looking back, what warning signs would you tell others to look for?
11. If you could design one resource or service to help men who experience this, what would it be?
12. Is there anything else about your experience that I didn't ask but you think is important?
13. Would you be willing to be contacted again for follow-up questions or to review findings?

Tips:

1. Use trauma-informed language: remind participants they can skip questions and stop at any time.
2. Avoid blaming wording (no "why did you send the photo?"); prefer "what factors influenced your choice?"

Checklist of the interview:

1. Contact Stage

- ☐ Platform or channel used (app, DM, email, other)
- ☐ Description of first contact (tone, timing, content)
- ☐ What drew participant to continue conversation

2. Nude Photo Request

- ☐ When did the request occur (early / after multiple chats / after flirting)
- ☐ How was the request framed (flirtatious / “favor” / verification / relationship)
- ☐ Emotional reaction when asked
- ☐ Reason for sending or refusing

3. Perpetrator Identity

- ☐ Claimed identity details (age, gender, job, location)
- ☐ Any suspicious signs detected
- ☐ Specific directions about photo (pose, angle, face shown or hidden)

4. Coercion / Blackmail Onset

- ☐ When coercion began (immediate / delayed / after prior sharing)
- ☐ Type of threat (public release / send to family / workplace / other)
- ☐ Nature of demand (money / more photos / silence / other)
- ☐ Were deadlines or ultimatums given

5. Financial Extortion

- ☐ Asked to pay?
- ☐ Payment details (method, amount, frequency)
- ☐ Whether participant complied
- ☐ Reason for paying (fear / coercion / embarrassment / belief it would end)

6. Emotional & Behavioral Impact

- ☐ Emotional responses (shame / fear / anger / anxiety)
- ☐ Impacts on daily life (sleep / work / relationships / routine)
- ☐ Behavioral changes (account deletion / app avoidance / privacy adjustments)

7. Responses & Reporting

- ☐ Attempted negotiation with blackmailer (yes/no, outcome)
- ☐ Reported to platform (yes/no, response)

- ☐ Reported to police or authority (yes/no, response)
- ☐ Discussed with others (friends / family / professional)
- ☐ Reactions of others

8. Additional Notes

- ☐ Any evidence kept (screenshots, receipts, message logs)
- ☐ Desired support or future advice mentioned
- ☐ Participant's closing thoughts